SkillNavora

MODULE 28 HANDBOOK

Module 28: Certification Preparation and Learning Roadmap

2 sections, 4 topics explained, plus the detailed lessons, examples, exercises and official links.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

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Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

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Module 28: Certification Preparation and Learning Roadmap

Level: All levels. How to prepare for Salesforce certifications and a realistic 12-month plan. Certification names must be checked on Trailhead before you register.

Contents

1. 28.1 Certification preparation
2. 28.2 Learning roadmap

Detailed lessons

Module 28

28.1 Certifications and the roadmap

WHAT IS IT?

> Salesforce certifications change over time. Check the official Trailhead credentials catalogue for active names, prerequisites, exam objectives and weighting. The roadmap in this academy gives a 12-month study plan.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> A current, recognised certification helps screening, but experience matters more.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Open the official credentials list on Trailhead and note active names.
2. Read the exam guide for the one you choose.
3. Follow the 12-month roadmap.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> Plan: months 1 to 3 fundamentals; months 4 to 8 applied labs; months 9 to 12 projects and exam.

COMMON ERRORS

Registering before the exam guide is read.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

How would you prepare for an SFMC certification?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Write your own 12-month plan using the template.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce Trailhead credentials (official)

28.1 Certification preparation: every topic explained

Verify active certifications on the official Trailhead credentials list. Check the Trailhead credentials catalogue for the current names before planning.

Exam objectives for each active certification (next batch). Exam guides list objectives and weightings; read them on Trailhead.

Practice questions (next batch). Practice with official Trailhead resources and practice tests.

28.2 Learning roadmap: every topic explained

Stage 1 to Stage 9 (see the 12-month roadmap PDF). A nine-stage plan across 12 months; see the roadmap PDF and tracker.

12-month roadmap

Stage	Topics	Study time	Milestone	Assessment
Stage 1 · Months 1 to 2	CRM and marketing fundamentals, Salesforce ecosystem, SFMC basics (Modules 1 to 3)	About 8 hours a week	Lifecycle map, metrics calculations, business unit design	Explain the lifecycle and metrics in an interview-style answer
Stage 2 · Months 3 to 4	Contacts, data architecture, data extensions, import and cleaning (Modules 4 and 5)	About 10 hours a week	Customer data extension with keys and a clean import	Import a file with planted duplicates and fix it
Stage 3 · Months 5 to 6	SQL for SFMC, HTML and CSS, JavaScript basics, AMPscript (Modules 6, 9 and 10)	About 12 hours a week	Ten SQL queries, a responsive email, ten AMPscript personalisations	Code review and a timed SQL test
Stage 4 · Months 7 to 8	Email Studio, Content Builder, Journey Builder, Automation Studio (Modules 7, 8, 11 and 12)	About 12 hours a week	Welcome journey, abandoned cart journey, scheduled automation	Journey and automation walkthrough
Stage 5 · Months 9 to 10	CloudPages, Mobile Studio, personalisation, analytics, APIs and integrations (Modules 13 to 18)	About 12 hours a week	CloudPage form, REST integration, API-triggered email	API demo with Postman and error handling
Stage 6 · Month 11	Data Cloud, advanced automation, security, deliverability, testing and architecture (Modules 19 to 23)	About 10 hours a week	Architecture document and a troubleshooting report	Architecture presentation and scenario answers
Stage 7 · Month 12	AI in marketing, capstone projects, portfolio, interviews and certification planning (Modules 24, 26 to 28)	About 15 hours a week	Two capstone projects published with demo videos	Three mock interviews and a certification plan